

From regenerative farming, carbon-neutral production, upcycled ingredients, and edible packaging, among others, innovation is at the core of sustainable gastronomy,” says Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Executive Chef of Mövenpick Resort Al Marjan Island, Ras Al Khaimah.

Adds Saravana Bhagavath, Chef of Four Seasons Resort Mauritius at Anahita, “It is important to create menus that prioritise zero waste, where every part of the ingredient is used creatively, from root to stem. This reduces environmental impact and ensures the sustainability of the entire process.”

Regional Comfort Food: Nostalgia is Back

In a world of molecular gastronomy and overly modernised menus, diners are returning to the comfort of honest, traditional cuisine. Regional food that tells a story and stirs memories is taking centre stage. “In 2025, food will be about creating an emotional connection with diners through authenticity,” says Sethi. Adds Sahni, of The Westin Hyderabad Mindspace, “Consumers will explore more local flavours, artisanal products, and traditional recipes. These trends highlight a shift toward healthier, more sustainable, and culturally rooted food experiences.”

Plant-based Foods

“The demand for plant-based foods, including meat substitutes and dairy alternatives, will grow as people focus more on health, the environment, and ethical choices,” says Sahni. Agrees Singh of Mövenpick Resort Al Marjan Island, “More people are gravitating towards plants for protein and alternative meat that mimic the texture and taste of animal-based counterparts.”



PICTURE COURTESY THE WESTIN HYDERABAD MINDSPACE

True to Form

“True to form” is back and is here to stay, says chef-entrepreneur Tarun Sibal. “Guests want chicken or mutton that feels, looks, and tastes like chicken or mutton. They are done with oranges that taste like apples, look like bananas and have a hint of peach somewhere,” he says. Sibal, who runs various restaurants and bars in Delhi, Goa, and Bengaluru, including KhiKhi and Titlie, says people dine for lip-smacking food; everything else could be a plus. “Once it’s yum, I have no issues with it being gluten-free, vegetarian, lactose-free, sustainable, forage-based, etc.,” he adds.

Spotlight on Heritage Indian Spirits

The year 2025 will shine a spotlight on heritage Indian spirits, as consumers rediscover and embrace home-grown expressions that are rooted in India’s rich cultural traditions, believes Vikram Achanta, Founder and CEO of Tullecho, a

beverage education and consultancy firm.

“Spirit-led and spirit-specific bars are also on the rise, with curated menus showcasing the unique profiles of individual spirits such as gin, whisky, and rum, fostering deeper connections between guests and their drinks,” he adds. Barfly in Goa and Mezcalita in Mumbai are examples of bars with agave-focused menus, while MTW in Goa focusses on gin, and Bar Outrigger, also in Goa, is heralding rum.

Bartenders Owning Bars

Expect a lot more bartender-owned and -run bars, says Minakshi Singh, Co-founder of New Delhi-based Sidecar and Gurugram-based Cocktails and Dreams and The Brook. “We would also see a lot more of internal local flavours coming in; there will be more storytelling from regional places, Tier II towns, and a lot of cultural integration,” she says.

While a lot of Indian cultural